

ConnectClips Operator's Manual

A step-by-step guide for the volunteer who turns Sunday's sermon into a week of short-form videos for YouTube Shorts, Facebook Reels, Instagram Reels, and TikTok.

What this tool does

You drop a sermon recording in. ConnectClips:

1. Transcribes the audio.
2. Asks Claude to pick the most clip-worthy moments and rate each one's hook strength.
3. Scans the whole sermon once for faces so trimming and exporting stay fast later on.
4. Reframes each pick from horizontal (16:9) to vertical (9:16) with face tracking.
5. Burns in word-by-word karaoke-style captions.
6. Hands you a 1080×1920 MP4 ready to upload to short-form platforms.

You then trim, export, download, and schedule each clip on each platform.

Before your first session

You need three things:

- **The URL** to access ConnectClips. Either `http://localhost:8765/` if you're sitting at the streaming PC, or the Tailscale URL if you're working from a laptop on the church's tailnet.
 - **The admin password**, only if you'll be deleting old sermons. (Volunteers don't need it for the day-to-day workflow.)
 - **A YouTube account login** for Connect Community Church's channel, plus FB/IG/TikTok if you'll be cross-posting.
-

The weekly rhythm

Sunday morning – Service livestream.
Sunday afternoon – Mike edits and uploads the sermon-only video to YouTube
(separate from the full livestream).
Sun pm / Mon am – YOU do everything below. ~1.5 hours total.
Mon–Fri – Scheduled posts go live automatically. Nothing for you to do.

You start as soon as the Mike has uploaded the sermon-only — typically Sunday afternoon or evening. Whether you do the work Sunday night or Monday morning is up to you, **but the first clip needs to be scheduled before noon Monday so it can post that day.**

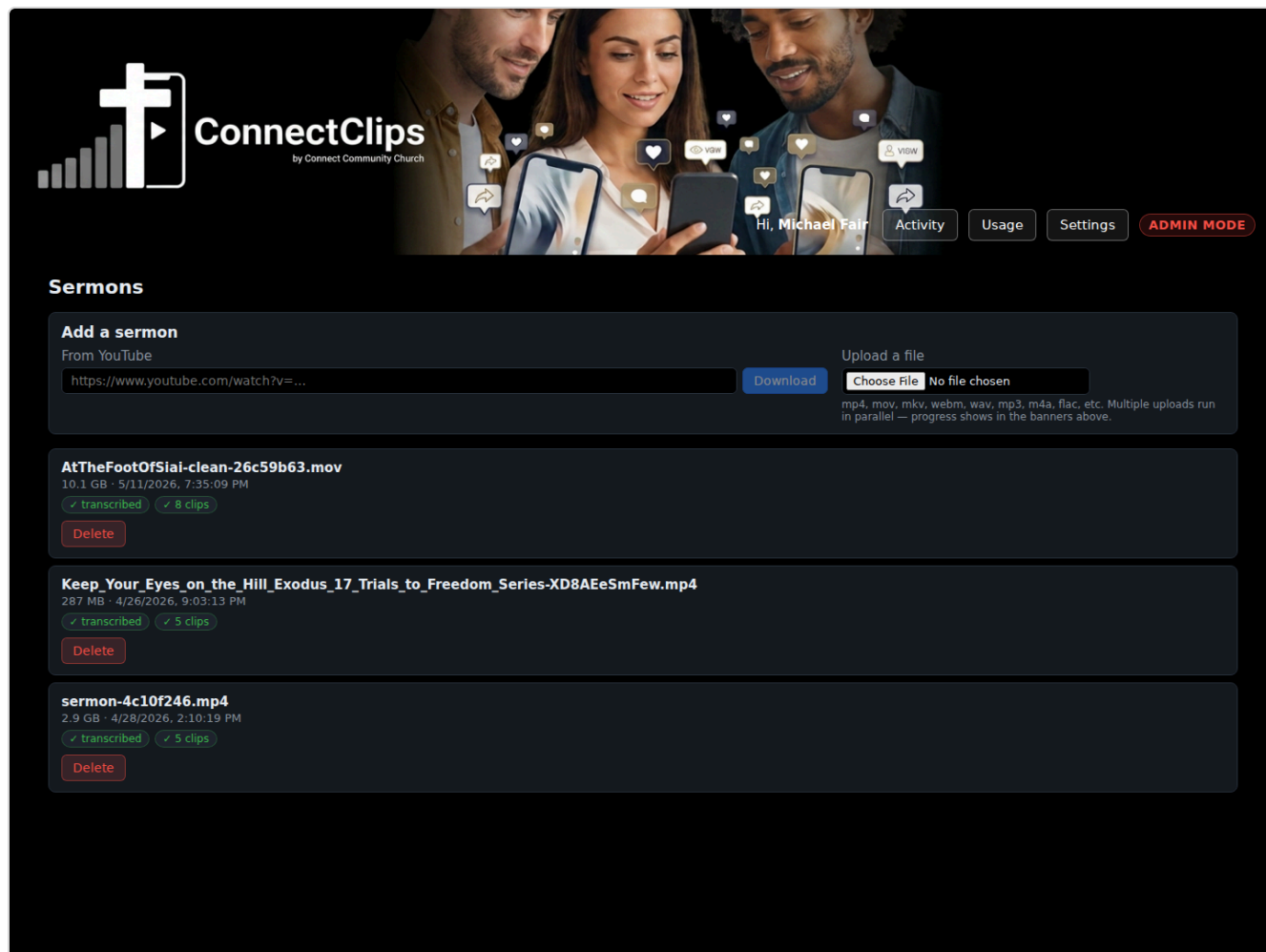
If life gets in the way and you don't get to it until Monday afternoon, that's fine — shift the schedule to **Tuesday through Saturday** instead. Both cadences work; just pick one and be consistent week to week.

The whole flow ends with five clips queued across three places (YouTube Studio, Meta Business Suite, TikTok), set to drop one per day for five days running.

The full workflow, start to finish

Step 1 — Open ConnectClips

Open the URL in any browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari).



You'll see a list of sermons. Each one has two status badges:

- **Transcribed** — green ✓ once the words have been extracted.
- **N clips** — green ✓ once Claude has picked clip candidates.

If both are green, you can skip ahead to Step 4.

Step 2 — Add this week's sermon

In the **Add a sermon** panel at the top:

Option A — From YouTube (recommended)

Paste the URL of this week's **sermon-only** YouTube upload (not the full livestream).

Add a sermon
From YouTube
Download

Upload a file
 No file chosen

mp4, mov, mkv, webm, wav, mp3, m4a, flac, etc. Multiple uploads run in parallel — progress shows in the banners above.

Click **Download**. The button shows "Downloading..." while it pulls the video. When it finishes, the new sermon appears in the list below.

Option B — File upload

If the sermon is a local file, click **Choose File**, pick the video or audio, and wait for "Uploading..." to finish.

Step 3 — Run the pipeline

Click the new sermon's row to open its detail page.

Hi, Michael Fair

Activity

Usage

Settings

ADMIN MODE

← Back

Delete sermon

AtTheFootOfSiai-clean-26c59b63.mov

Full sermon YouTube URL ✓ adUgdK2YiJQ

1. Transcribe ✓ done

2. Pick clips Range to ✓ 8 clips Re-run

Suggested clips

76

How Scary Is God Really?

10:12.3 - 11:14.8 · 62.5s ✓ exported by Michael Fair · 1h ago

The rapid-fire rhetorical questions about God's scariness, holiness, and worthiness of worship create instant tension and curiosity without requiring any prior context, and the payoff—explaining that 'how' is not a question but an exclamation of awe—lands cleanly within the clip.

Hook: The first words out of the speaker's mouth are 'How scary is God?'—a blunt, provocative question that challenges the viewer's assumptions and demands an answer, stopping a cold scroller in their tracks.

Re-trim & export

74

Let's Face It: We Are Unholy

16:38.8 - 17:52.8 · 74.0s

The blunt confession 'we are unholy' immediately creates contrast against a holy God, and the clip pivots into vivid shock-and-awe imagery of the mountain in fire, smoke, and thunder, giving the viewer both a theological provocation and a cinematic payoff.

Hook: 'And let's face it—we are unholy' is a bold, self-implicating statement that most scrollers won't expect from a pastor, creating immediate curiosity about where the thought is going.

Preview / trim / export

73

The Israelites Were Right To Fear God

37:36.0 - 38:47.7 · 71.7s

The counterintuitive move of affirming that Israel's fear of God was correct—not a failure of faith—reframes fear of God as appropriate and earned, and the pivot to 'we are blessed far beyond the Israelites' gives cold viewers a reason to keep watching for the contrast.

Hook: 'The Israelites were afraid of God. They should be'—the blunt, two-sentence affirmation of divine fear is a contrarian opener that challenges the common assumption that fear of God is outdated or wrong.

Preview / trim / export

Full sermon YouTube URL (admin-only, one-time per sermon) — the row directly under the title. Paste the YouTube URL of the full sermon upload here so each clip's "Copy full-sermon link" button can deep-link viewers to the exact moment in the full sermon. The field auto-saves on blur and shows a green ✓ <video_id> badge when it parsed the URL successfully. Accepts `youtube.com/watch?v=...`, `youtu.be/...`, `/live/...`, `/shorts/...`. Volunteers see only a small read-only link when the URL is set — they don't edit it.

Two numbered steps:

1. Transcribe — Click **Run transcribe**. This takes 5–15 minutes for a typical sermon. The button reads "Running..." while it works. Walk away; you don't need to babysit it.

Once transcribe finishes, two things happen automatically in parallel and you don't have to click anything for either:

- **Clip selection** — Claude reads the transcript and picks 7–10 candidate clips with hook scores. Usually finishes in 30–60 seconds.
- **Face scan** — every face in the sermon is located and tracked once, so the trim view loads instantly later. Takes 5–15 minutes on a 50-minute sermon, runs in the background, and is the reason the pipeline shows two activity rows after a transcribe.

2. Pick clips — once transcribe is done, the **Range** controls become available. The default "3 to 8" means Claude will return between 3 and 8 candidate clips.



2. Pick clips Range 3 to 8 ✓ 8 clips Re-run

For a typical sermon, **leave it at 3 to 8** the first time. If you want more options to choose from, change it to **5 to 10** before clicking. If you only want the very best moments, try **2 to 3**.

Click **Run clip selection**. This usually takes 30–60 seconds. When it's done, the page shows a list of suggested clips below.

Step 4 — Review & trim each clip

Each suggested clip is a card showing:

- The clip's title (Claude wrote it; you can change it later when you upload)
- The time range and duration
- A **hook score** out of 100 — Claude's prediction of how well the first 3 seconds will stop a cold scroller's thumb. Use this to sequence your week — see Step 7.
- A short rationale — *why Claude thinks this moment will perform well*

Suggested clips

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Hook: 'The Israelites were afraid of God. They should be'—the blunt, two-sentence affirmation of divine fear is a contrarian opener that challenges the common assumption that fear of God is outdated or wrong.

Preview / trim / export

71

Are You At The Foot Of Sinai?

39:00.9 - 40:08.2 · 67.3s

The direct second-person challenge 'Are you coming close to God?' turns the entire sermon into a personal invitation, and the clip closes on a concrete promise—God holds out far more than the world ever can—making it a self-contained evangelistic moment.

Hook: 'So are you at the foot of Mount Sinai? Are you coming close to God?'—two rapid questions aimed directly at the viewer create immediate personal stakes and a sense that this moment demands a decision.

Preview / trim / export

65

God Is Holy In Every Way

30:41.8 - 31:46.8 · 65.0s

The preacher's rapid-fire list—'He created us, He provides, He saves, He loves, He died for us'—builds into a crescendo that is emotionally satisfying and self-contained, making a complete case for why God's holiness demands a response.

Hook: Opening with 'God is holy in all ways—do we understand this?' is a direct challenge to the viewer that creates mild urgency, though it's a conventional declaration rather than a truly arresting statement.

Preview / trim / export

63

The Only Conditional Covenant God Ever Made

21:34.7 - 22:57.0 · 82.3s

The contrast between the one conditional covenant at Sinai and God's unconditional covenants with Abraham, David, and Noah is a theologically striking and self-contained argument that resolves cleanly when the Israelites say 'all that the Lord has spoken, we will do.'

Hook: 'Hey, this is a conditional covenant'—the casual 'hey' and the specific theological claim land with mild intrigue, but the term 'conditional covenant' is insider language that may not immediately arrest a cold viewer.

Preview / trim / export

59

Israel's First Face-to-Face With God

12:18.0 - 13:47.1 · 89.1s

The idea that Israel had seen miracles but never actually come face-to-face with God is a genuinely surprising observation that frames the entire Sinai encounter in a fresh, relatable way, and the clip closes on God setting a boundary—a complete thought.

Hook: The opener—'And I think this first close encounter with God by the Israelites tells us a lot'—is conversational and mildly intriguing but leans on a setup phrase, which costs it momentum in the critical first three seconds.

Preview / trim / export

58

Christ In You: The Hope Of Glory

35:36.3 - 36:45.6 · 69.3s

Anchoring the clip in a well-known Colossians quote gives it scriptural weight, and the preacher's personal wonder—'The other thing that amazes me'—humanizes the theological claim, closing on the unconditional promise as a complete thought.

Hook: 'The other thing that amazes me' is a warm but soft opener that signals something interesting is coming without immediately delivering it, requiring two or three seconds before the payoff phrase 'Christ in you' arrives.

Preview / trim / export

Click **Preview / trim / export** on the first clip. You'll land in the trim view.

[← Back](#)

74 Let's Face It: We Are Unholy

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Source video — scrub to find frame, then set in / out



16:38 / 42:49

Start -0.1s +0.1s ⏮ playhead ⏭ go

End -0.1s +0.1s ⏮ playhead ⏭ go

Duration: 1:14.02

▶ Play range (loop) Loop: off Hello there preview Classic — yellow highlight ▾ ☒ Hook title overlay

[Export vertical clip](#)

Preview — drag captions up/down to position



Zoom

☐ Lock camera (no tracking)

Track which face?

No export yet.

The vertical preview on the right starts up almost immediately because the face scan ran during ingest. (If you opened the trim view *before* the face scan finished, you'll briefly see "Scanning faces..." while it catches up — usually a few seconds, occasionally a few minutes if the scan is still running.)

The left side shows the full sermon video. Scrub it like any normal video player.

The trim controls (under the video):

Control	What it does
Start / End number boxes	Type a precise time, or use the buttons to nudge
−0.1s / +0.1s	Shift start or end by a tenth of a second
↓ playhead	Set start (or end) to wherever the video is currently parked
⏮ go	Jump the video to the current start (or end). Use this to <i>check</i> what frame you've set.
▶ Play range (loop)	Plays just the trimmed range and loops, so you can hear how the clip will feel
Loop: on / off	Toggle the loop on or off
Export vertical clip	Kick off the reframing + caption pipeline

Typical trim sequence:

1. Click **▶ Play range (loop)** to hear the clip Claude picked.
2. Listen to the very start. If it cuts in awkwardly, click pause where you want to start, then **↓ playhead** on the Start row.
3. Listen to the very end. If the last word is clipped, **⏮ go** on the End row to see the last frame, then **+0.1s** until it sounds clean.
4. Re-loop with **▶ Play range** to confirm.

If the sermon has more than one speaker on camera (a guest, a panel, an interview), a small **face strip** appears under the preview with one thumbnail per face the scanner found, plus an **Auto** pill. Click a thumbnail to lock the reframing onto that person; click **Auto** to let it pick the most prominent face per moment (the default and almost always right for a solo sermon, where the strip won't appear at all).

Framing controls (Zoom + Lock camera)

Below the preview is a small **Zoom** row with four buttons, plus a **Lock camera** toggle. These let you tune how the clip is framed without re-running anything — change a setting and the preview updates within a second. The choice is saved per clip and applied at export.

Zoom	What it does	When to pick it
Tight	Closer crop — fills the frame with the pastor's face + shoulders.	When you want a "talking head" focus. Use sparingly — easy to feel like a mugshot.
Medium (default)	More pastor + background visible. Reads as natural framing.	Almost always. Start here.
Wide	Widest crop the source allows — full body / stage context where there's enough source frame.	When the moment is more visual than vocal (gesture, walking, prop).
Stage	Shows the entire source frame letterboxed onto a blurred copy of itself. No face tracking — the whole frame is always visible.	When the pastor moves around a lot, or when the full-frame stage context tells the story better than a tight crop. Most polished-looking on its own — no jitter possible.

Lock camera (no tracking) — the toggle below the zoom buttons. Off by default. When on, the crop holds perfectly still at the pastor's average position over the clip — zero motion at all. Use it for clips where the pastor stays put and you want absolute stillness (no following at all, even subtle). If he walks while it's on, he'll walk out of frame; that's the tradeoff.

The toggle hides on Stage mode (Stage already shows the full frame — there's nothing to lock).

When happy, click **Export vertical clip**. It runs for ~30-60 seconds. Don't navigate away.

Step 5 — Verify the export

The exported clip appears in the right column and starts auto-playing on loop.

ConnectClips
by Connect Community Church

Activity Usage Settings **ADMIN MODE**

← Back

76 How Scary Is God Really?

The rapid-fire rhetorical questions about God's scariness, holiness, and worthiness of worship create instant tension and curiosity without requiring any prior context, and the payoff—explaining that 'how' is not a question but an exclamation of awe—lands cleanly within the clip.

Source video — scrub to find frame, then set in / out

10:12 / 42:49

Start: 10:12.29 —0.1s +0.1s ↓ playhead □ go

End: 11:14.81 —0.1s +0.1s ↓ playhead □ go

Duration: 1:02.52

▶ Play range (loop) Loop: off Hello there preview Classic — yellow highlight ▾ ☒ Hook title overlay Reset position

Reset to suggestion Export vertical clip

Preview — drag captions up/down to position

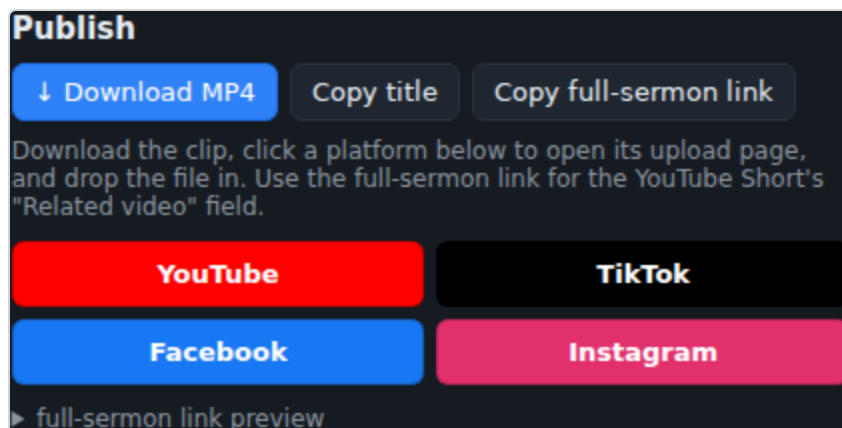
Watch it once start to finish. Check three things:

- **Pastor stays in frame.** Some moments may show the slide artwork — that's fine if it's a slide-only moment in the source. If the entire clip is slide art with no pastor, you probably need to re-trim past that section.
- **Captions appear** with the current word highlighted in yellow.
- **The end isn't cut off mid-word.** If it is, re-trim with end +0.3s or so and re-export.

If the clip is bad, just re-trim and click **Export vertical clip** again. It'll overwrite the previous version.

Step 6 — Publish (download + cross-post)

Below the preview is the **Publish** panel.



Three action buttons across the top:

- **↓ Download MP4** — saves the clip to your Downloads folder. You'll drag this file into each platform's upload page.
- **Copy title** — puts Claude's title on your clipboard. Paste into the platform's caption field.
- **Copy full-sermon link** — shows when the sermon has a Full sermon YouTube URL set (Step 3) **or** the source was ingested from YouTube and the filename still has the video ID. Either way, it's the URL of the original sermon at the exact timestamp the clip was taken from. **Critical for YouTube Shorts** — paste it into the "Related Video" field so viewers can click through to the full sermon.

Below those are four colored platform buttons:

Button	Opens	What you do
YouTube (red)	YouTube Studio	Upload the MP4. Set Visibility to Schedule . Paste the full-sermon link in the Related Video field.
TikTok (black)	TikTok upload page	Drop the MP4. Toggle Schedule and set the time.
Facebook (blue)	Facebook Reels Composer	Drop the MP4. From a Page, you can also use Meta Business Suite for cleaner scheduling.
Instagram (pink)	Instagram Reels upload	Drop the MP4. (IG strongly prefers mobile — see "Posting from your phone" below.)

Step 7 — Schedule, don't post

Don't click "Post Now" on any platform. Always **Schedule** instead. Recommended cadence: **5 clips per week, one per day at noon, for five consecutive days** — Mon-Fri if you finished the work on Sunday night, or Tue-Sat if you got to it on Monday afternoon.

Sequence by hook strength, regardless of which day you start:

Day of the run	Use the clip that...
Day 1	has the highest hook score
Day 2	has the second-highest hook score
Day 3	is a teaching/insight moment
Day 4	is a story/testimony moment
Day 5	is encouraging or applicable

The hook score on each clip card is your fastest sort. For Days 3–5, read each clip's **rationale** to figure out which is which.

The strongest hook goes first because Day 1 gets the most algorithmic momentum on YouTube Shorts and TikTok — they boost newly active channels harder when the first post performs well.

Step 8 — Repeat for the remaining clips

Go back (← Back button), pick the next clip, repeat Steps 4–7. Each clip takes about 5–10 minutes once you have the rhythm.

Posting from your phone

For **Instagram Reels** specifically, the web upload is unreliable. The flow that actually works:

1. Email yourself the downloaded MP4 (or save to OneDrive / Google Drive).
2. Open it on your phone.
3. Open Instagram → New Post → Reel.
4. Select the MP4 from your phone's gallery.
5. Paste the title from a note you've prepped on your phone.
6. Schedule.

Same trick works for TikTok if the web flow gives you trouble.

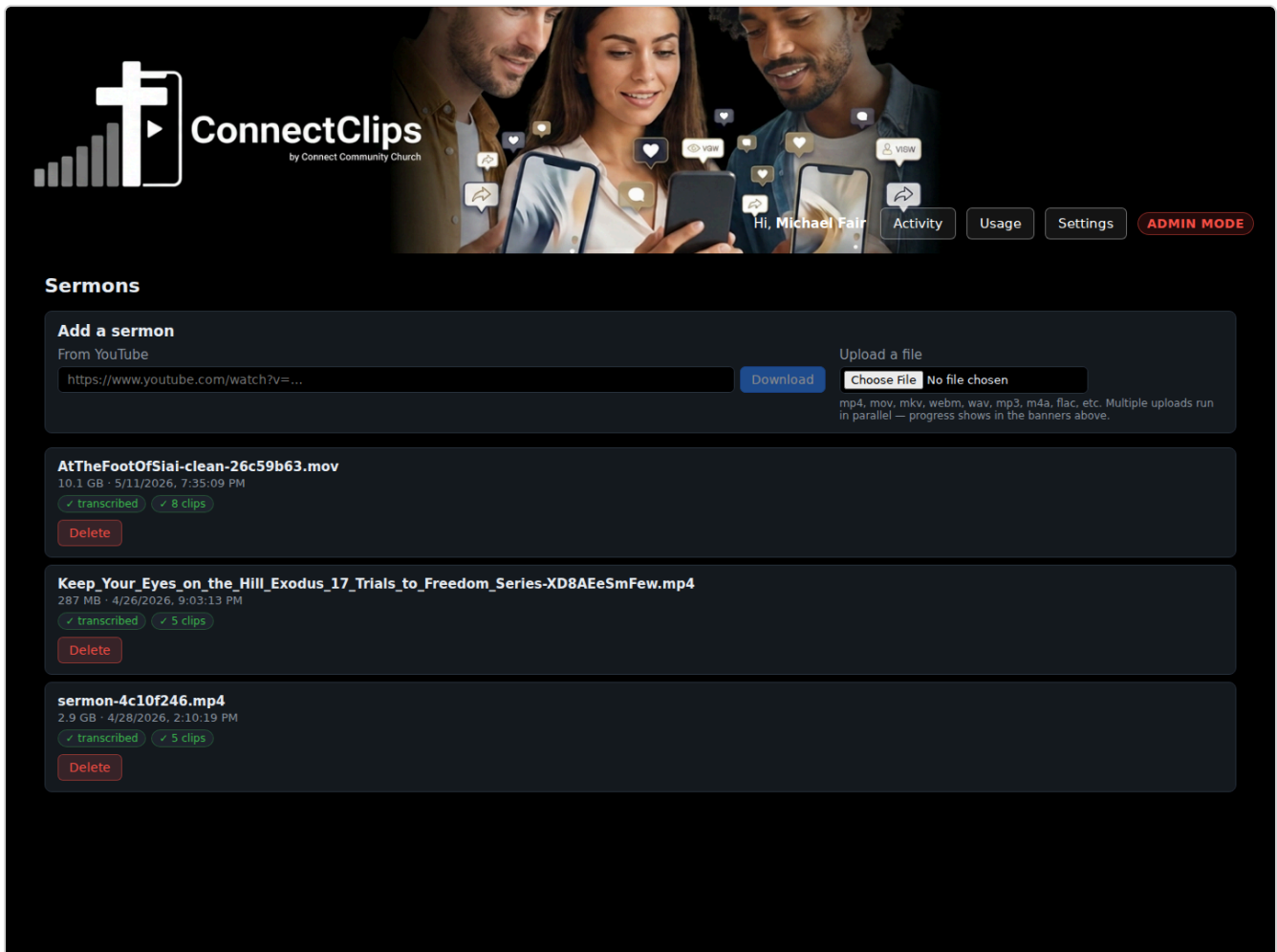
Admin mode (deleting old sermons)

This is for the Mike, not day-to-day volunteers. To free up disk space when an old sermon is no longer needed:

1. Click **Enter admin mode** in the top-right of the header.



2. Type the admin password and press Enter. The button swaps to a red **ADMIN MODE** badge with an Exit button.



3. Each sermon row now has a red **Delete** button. Clicking it asks you to confirm, then removes: - The source video file - The transcript - The clips.json (Claude's picks) - Every exported MP4 from that sermon

This is **permanent**. Don't delete a sermon you might want to re-clip later.

4. Click **Exit** when you're done. Always exit admin mode before walking away from the computer.
-

Activity log (admin-only)

The **Activity** button in the header (visible when you're in admin mode) opens a table of every recent pipeline job — downloads, transcribes, clip selections, face prescans, and exports. Use it when a volunteer asks "I uploaded a sermon and nothing's happening" — Activity tells you whether the job is queued, mid-run, or failed.

The screenshot shows the ConnectClips web application interface. At the top left is the ConnectClips logo with a cross icon and the text "by Connect Community Church". To the right of the logo is a header image of three people looking at a smartphone. Below the header image are buttons for "Usage", "Settings", and "ADMIN MODE" (highlighted in red). Below the header image is a "Hi, Michael Fair" greeting. Below the header image are buttons for "← Back" and "Refresh". Below the header image is the "Activity" section. The "Activity" section has a subtitle "Most recent 200 actions across all users. Refreshes every 5 seconds." and a filter input field "Filter — user, sermon, kind, status...". Below the filter is a table with 6 columns: "When", "Who", "What", "Status", "Duration", and "Output". The table contains 20 rows of activity logs. The first 10 rows are for Michael Fair, and the next 10 rows are for anon. The table shows various actions like "Export clip", "prescan_faces", "Pick clips", "Transcribe", and "Upload". The status column shows "done" (green) or "failed" (red). The duration column shows time in minutes and seconds. The output column shows a "Download" link.

When	Who	What	Status	Duration	Output
May 11, 08:59 PM	Michael Fair	Export clip 0 of AtTheFootOfSiai-clean-26c59...	done	1m 8s	Download
May 11, 08:34 PM	Michael Fair	Export clip 0 of AtTheFootOfSiai-clean-26c59...	done	1m 5s	Download
May 11, 07:43 PM	Michael Fair	prescan_faces	done	37m 23s	
May 11, 07:43 PM	Michael Fair	Pick clips for AtTheFootOfSiai-clean-26c59b63....	done	2m 29s	
May 11, 07:35 PM	Michael Fair	Transcribe AtTheFootOfSiai-clean-26c59b63....	done	8m 46s	
May 11, 06:41 PM	Michael Fair	Upload AtTheFootOfSiai-clean.mov	done	53m 27s	
May 9, 09:48 AM	Michael Fair	Export clip 0 of Keep_Your_Eyes_on_the_Hill_...	done	30s	Download
May 8, 07:49 PM	Michael Fair	Export clip 0 of Keep_Your_Eyes_on_the_Hill_...	done	29s	Download
May 2, 01:53 AM	Michael Fair	Pick clips for Keep_Your_Eyes_on_the_Hill_Exod...	done	2m 49s	
May 1, 02:08 AM	anon	Export clip 1 of sermon-4c10f246.mp4	done	44s	Download
May 1, 01:58 AM	Michael Fair	Export clip 4 of sermon-4c10f246.mp4	done	54s	Download
May 1, 01:22 AM	Michael Fair	Export clip 4 of sermon-4c10f246.mp4	done	52s	Download
May 1, 12:45 AM	anon	Export clip 0 of sermon-4c10f246.mp4	failed	10m 10s	
May 1, 12:28 AM	Michael Fair	Export clip 4 of sermon-4c10f246.mp4	done	16m 14s	Download
Apr 30, 11:10 AM	Michael Fair	Export clip 0 of Keep_Your_Eyes_on_the_Hill_...	done	42s	Download
Apr 30, 09:30 AM	Michael Fair	Export clip 0 of Keep_Your_Eyes_on_the_Hill_...	done	41s	Download

Each row shows:

- **When** the job ran
- **Kind** — `youtube_download`, `transcribe`, `select_clips`, `prescan_faces`, `export_clip`
- **Sermon** it was operating on
- **Who** triggered it (Tailscale login or "anonymous" if entered via password)
- **Status** — running (with a live progress bar), done, or failed (with the error message in red)

Long-running jobs update in place — you don't need to refresh.

Anthropic API usage (admin-only)

The **Usage** button shows the running tally of Claude API spend per sermon, plus a top-up history if you've recorded any. Mike uses this to keep an eye on the API budget — typical sermon costs ~\$0.05, so the monthly tally on a once-a-week schedule should be a few dollars at most.

The screenshot shows the ConnectClips Admin Mode interface. At the top, there's a header with the ConnectClips logo and a navigation bar with buttons for Activity, Settings, and ADMIN MODE. Below the header, there's a section for API Usage, which includes an estimated balance of \$8.39, topped up since April 30, 2026, and spent since the first top-up of \$0.36. There's also a top-up history table with one entry for April 30, 2026, for \$8.75. Below this is a spend section with a table showing the estimated total spend of \$0.49, clip selections of 3, average per sermon of \$0.16, output tokens of 22,162, cache writes of 41,462, and cache reads of 0. The spend table lists three sermons with their respective costs: \$0.17, \$0.20, and \$0.13.

ConnectClips
by Connect Community Church

Hi, Michael Fair

Activity Settings **ADMIN MODE**

← Back Refresh

API Usage

Anthropic Claude API usage and estimated cost across all clip-selection runs. Numbers reflect what ConnectClips spent on this API key — any other usage on the same key is not included. Cost is computed locally from the model's published rate card.

ESTIMATED BALANCE
\$8.39

Topped up: **\$8.75** since Apr 30, 2026
Spent since first top-up: **\$0.36**

[Top up at Anthropic →](#)
[Log a top-up](#)

▼ **Top-up history (1)**

Date	Amount	Note	
Apr 30, 2026, 11:12 PM	\$8.75	Balance after Initial testing from \$10 initial load.	Remove

Spend

ESTIMATED TOTAL SPEND	CLIP SELECTIONS	AVG PER SERMON	OUTPUT TOKENS	CACHE WRITES	CACHE READS
\$0.49	3	\$0.16	22,162	41,462	0

Sermon	When	Model	Input	Output	Cache write	Cache read	Cost
AtTheFootOfSiai-clean-26c59b63.mov	May 11, 2026, 07:46 PM	claude-sonnet-4-6	3	7,376	14,808	0	\$0.17
Keep_Your_Eyes_on_the_Hill_Exodus_17_Trials_to_Fr...	May 2, 2026, 01:55 AM	claude-sonnet-4-6	3	10,162	11,680	0	\$0.20
sermon-4c10f246.mp4	Apr 29, 2026, 03:39 AM	claude-sonnet-4-6	3	4,624	14,974	0	\$0.13

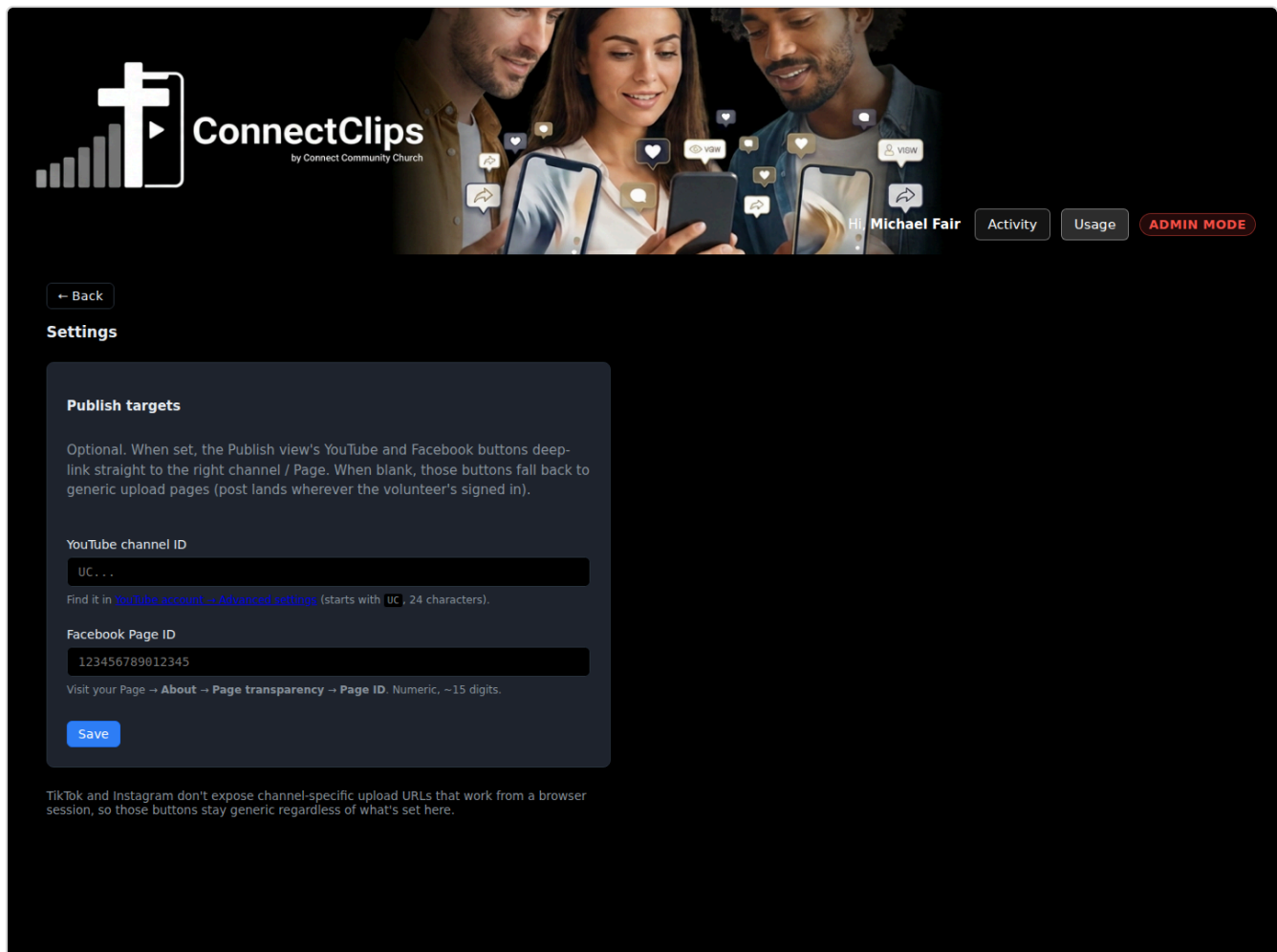
Cost is estimated using Anthropic's published rate card (Sonnet 4.6: \$3 / \$15 / \$3.75 / \$0.30 per million tokens for input / output / cache-write / cache-read). For authoritative billing, see your [Anthropic console](#).

Two things volunteers don't need to touch but can ask about:

- **Estimated balance** — what's left of the most recent top-up (manually recorded; the API doesn't expose a balance, so this is just our running notebook).
- **Per-sermon table** — input/output tokens and cost for the clip-selection call on each sermon. If a number looks unusually high, the sermon was probably very long; that's the model retrieving more transcript.

Settings (admin-only)

The **Settings** button is where the publish-target accounts get configured. By default the platform buttons in the Publish panel open generic upload pages — whatever account is signed into your browser is what posts. Setting the church's YouTube channel ID and Facebook Page ID here makes those buttons deep-link straight to the right destination, so a volunteer signed into both their personal and the church account doesn't accidentally cross-post to the wrong one.



The screenshot shows the ConnectClips interface. At the top left is the logo, a stylized cross with a play button inside, and the text "ConnectClips by Connect Community Church". To the right is a header image of three people looking at a phone. Below the image are buttons for "Activity", "Usage", and "ADMIN MODE" (highlighted in red). A "Back" button is in the top left of the settings area. The "Settings" title is below the back button. The main content area is titled "Publish targets" and contains two input fields: "YouTube channel ID" with a placeholder "UC..." and "Facebook Page ID" with a placeholder "123456789012345". Below each field is a small text instruction. A "Save" button is at the bottom of the settings area. At the very bottom, a note states: "TikTok and Instagram don't expose channel-specific upload URLs that work from a browser session, so those buttons stay generic regardless of what's set here."

Publish targets

Optional. When set, the Publish view's YouTube and Facebook buttons deep-link straight to the right channel / Page. When blank, those buttons fall back to generic upload pages (post lands wherever the volunteer's signed in).

YouTube channel ID

UC...

Find it in [YouTube account → Advanced settings](#) (starts with UC, 24 characters).

Facebook Page ID

123456789012345

Visit your Page → **About** → **Page transparency** → **Page ID**. Numeric, ~15 digits.

Save

TikTok and Instagram don't expose channel-specific upload URLs that work from a browser session, so those buttons stay generic regardless of what's set here.

Both fields are optional. Empty = use the generic upload page (today's behavior). Filled in = deep-link.

Where to find the IDs — click the help links right under each input:

- **YouTube channel ID:** https://www.youtube.com/account_advanced while signed in to the church account. Starts with **UC**, 24 characters.
- **Facebook Page ID:** visit your Page → **About** → **Page transparency** → **Page ID**. Numeric, ~15 digits.

TikTok and Instagram stay generic regardless — neither platform exposes a channel-specific upload URL that works in a browser session. Volunteers still need to make sure they're signed into the right TikTok / Instagram account before clicking those buttons.

Troubleshooting

The page doesn't load at all. The backend isn't running. On the streaming PC, open WSL and run:

```
~/ConnectClips/scripts/start-server.sh
```

Then refresh.

"Admin password not configured" when I try to enter admin mode. Mike hasn't set `ADMIN_PASSWORD` in `backend/.env` on the streaming PC. Ask him to do that and restart the backend.

Transcribe is stuck on "Running..." for hours. Whisper occasionally hangs on weird audio. Refresh the page; if the badge still says "not transcribed," ask the Mike to check the WSL terminal for errors.

Clip selection returned the same 5 clips after I changed the range. Check that your range *excludes* whatever count Claude is consistently picking. If 5 is in the range, Claude may legitimately keep choosing 5 because that's how many strong moments exist in the sermon. Try `2 to 3` (force fewer) or `8 to 10` (force more).

The exported clip shows the slide artwork instead of the pastor. The pastor's PiP at that moment was too small for the face tracker to see. Three options: 1. Re-trim to start past the slide-heavy section (most common fix). 2. Accept it — slide artwork can look interesting and isn't a deal-breaker. 3. Pick a different clip from the suggestions list.

The reframing followed the wrong person (e.g. a guest instead of the pastor). If the face strip appeared under the preview, click the correct face thumbnail and re-export. If no strip appeared, the scanner only found one face throughout the sermon — which usually means the "wrong" face is actually the only face on camera in that moment.

The exported clip feels too zoomed in, or like a handheld camcorder. Below the preview, change **Zoom** from Medium to **Wide** or **Stage** and re-export. Stage shows the whole source frame on a blurred background — zero tracking, zero jitter, most polished. Wide pulls the crop out to show more of the pastor's body. If subtle wobble persists with face tracking, flip on **Lock camera (no tracking)** to freeze the crop entirely.

The full-sermon link doesn't appear on the Publish panel. Two ways to get the link: (a) admin sets the Full sermon YouTube URL on the sermon detail page (Step 3), or (b) the sermon was ingested via YouTube and the filename still contains the video ID. If neither is true, the button hides. Easiest fix: ask the admin to paste the YouTube URL on the sermon detail page.

The trim view sits on "Scanning faces..." for a long time. The face scan for this sermon hadn't finished yet when you clicked in. It runs in the background after transcribe; for a fresh upload it takes 5–15 minutes. Either wait a bit, or come back to this clip after working on a different sermon.

The last word is cut off. Re-trim with end pushed +0.3s and re-export. (As of recent updates, new clip selections automatically add a small breath-pad to avoid this.)

Captions are out of sync. Hard-refresh the browser (Ctrl+Shift+R). The browser may be playing a cached older version of the file.

Quick reference card

What you want to do	Where in the app
Add a sermon from YouTube	Sermon list → top panel → paste URL → Download
Upload a local file	Sermon list → top panel → Choose File
See what's already in progress	Sermon list — status badges on each row
Run transcribe	Sermon detail → Step 1 → Run transcribe
Pick clips (or re-pick)	Sermon detail → Step 2 → set range → Run / Re-run
Trim and export a clip	Click "Preview / trim / export" on a clip card
Pick which face to follow	Trim view → face strip under the preview (only shows when >1 face)
Change zoom level (Tight / Medium / Wide / Stage)	Trim view → Zoom buttons under the preview
Stop the crop from tracking	Trim view → Lock camera toggle under the Zoom buttons
Set the full-sermon YouTube URL	Sermon detail → "Full sermon YouTube URL" row under the title (admin only)
Download a finished clip	Trim view → Publish panel → ↓ Download MP4
Get the YouTube deep-link	Trim view → Publish panel → Copy full-sermon link
Open a platform's upload page	Trim view → Publish panel → colored platform button
Delete an old sermon	Header → Enter admin mode → Delete on the row
See what's running across all sermons	Header → Activity (admin-only)
Check Anthropic API spend	Header → Usage (admin-only)
Configure publish-target accounts (YT channel, FB Page)	Header → Settings (admin-only)

A note on what this tool can't do

ConnectClips picks moments and reframes them, but it doesn't (yet):

- Generate thumbnails (use the platform's auto-pick, or design one in Canva)
- Write platform-specific captions (Claude's title is a starting point; you'll polish it per platform)
- Detect what makes a clip "viral" (Claude is good at this but not infallible — your editorial judgment in the trim view is the safety net)
- Cross-post in one click (you'll schedule on each platform individually — see Step 7)

The trim view is your editorial gate. If a clip Claude picked feels off, skip it. Quality over quantity always wins on short-form.